

Mindfulness

OBJECTIVES:

1. REDUCE SUFFERING AND INCREASE HAPPINESS

- Reduce pain, tension and stress.

2. INCREASE CONTROL OF YOUR MIND

- Stop letting your mind be in control of you.

3. EXPERIENCE REALITY AS IT IS

- Live life with your eyes wide open.
- Experience the reality of your connection to the universe and essential “goodness” and validity.

This section Includes:

1	Introduction & States of Mind	2	Observe
3	Describe	4	Participate
5	Non-Judgementally	6	One-Mindfully
7	Effectively	8	Self-Compassion & Loving Kindness
9	Mindfulness of Emotions	10	Mindfulness of Thoughts
11	Grounding	12	Being & Doing Mind

MINDFULNESS SUMMARY SHEET

Mindfulness is...

"Awareness of present experience with acceptance"

- Opposite of "Automatic Pilot"
- Being in the here and now
- Observing
- Describing
- Participating
- *Non-judgmentally*
- *One-mindfully (one thing at a time)*
- *Effectively (doing what works and using skillful means)*
- Practiced through formal & informal exercises



Benefits of Mindfulness

- Increased self-awareness
- Increased sense of calm and wellness
- Being less attached to problems
- Being less overwhelmed
- Able to respond vs. react
- Learning that thoughts and feelings do not DEFINE you and don't have to control your life

"Observe, Describe, Participate – with a non-judgmental stance"

STATES OF MIND

"WHAT" SKILLS

"HOW" SKILLS

STATES OF MIND:

Reasonable Mind:

This is when we are viewing things logically, rationally and analytically, without factoring in any emotions or values.

Emotion Mind:

In this state we view things emotionally. We are ruled by our moods, feelings and urges to do or say things. Facts, logic and reason are not important.

Wise Mind:

Mindfulness helps us stay in this state of mind more often. In this mind state we consider things logically and rationally, while factoring in our feelings. Both reason and emotion are important.

"Wise Mind" is the wisdom within each person

THE "WHAT" SKILLS:

Observe:

Look at things as the bare experience. Experience using the five senses. Just see, hear, touch, smell and taste. Focus on what is there. Let go of your thoughts, descriptions, feelings and judgments about the experience. Let go of the story, just feel.

Describe:

Put the experience into words. Describe everything about the experience, even those things you may consider unimportant. Use factual descriptions, ie. "the table top is smooth and cold"; try to refrain from judgments.

Participate:

Consciously and actively participate in the experience. Don't just be an idle observer, step inside your experience and be a part of it. Example: "I feel my whole body breathing as I inhale and exhale; I am part of the breath"

THE "HOW" SKILLS:

Non-judgmentally (without judgment):

Separate the bare facts from your thoughts, judgments, feelings and opinions. When judgments come up, try to just notice them and let them go, returning to the focus of your mindful exercise.

One-mindfully (one thing at a time):

Do one thing at a time. Focus all your attention on every task you do. When you are drinking tea, just drink. When you are driving, just drive. When you are talking with someone, fully talk with them. Put everything you have into each thing you do, one at a time. When the mind moves away to other things, notice this and remind yourself to return to the task at hand.

Effectively (letting go of "right and wrong", doing what is helpful):

Do things to get things done effectively, don't worry about doing them the "right" way. What are you trying to achieve? What does this situation call for? What will work in this situation? Try to keep past experiences and resentments out of the picture. Reach your goal as effectively as you can.

Exercise 3: Mindfulness States of Mind

Describe an experience you have had with each of these states of mind:

REASONABLE MIND



EMOTION MIND



WISE MIND

